Warm-up / The cafe gets busier

Test another explanation

Name: _____ Date: _____

Suggested lesson time: 30 minutes. Work individually, then compare when invited.

Useful words

Alternative explanation: Another account that could fit the same observation.

Mechanism: A description of how a proposed cause could produce the outcome.

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: A cafe's lunchtime visits rise during the week it introduces music. A large office opens next door that same week. The owner credits the music.

Produce: Write one alternative explanation and one sentence stating what remains unknown.

Your steps

1. Use the new office to give an alternative to the music explanation.
2. Explain how it could increase lunchtime visits.
3. State whether the facts show which explanation contributed more.

Before you finish: Have you explained a connection while avoiding an unsupported verdict?

Your response

Main activity / Why did museum visits rise?

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: A museum's family visits rise from 200 to 320 during the first weekend of free admission. That weekend also brings a new dinosaur exhibit, a school holiday, and unusually heavy rain. The museum credits free admission alone.

Produce: Write three possible explanations with reasons, then one proposed comparison for a chosen rival.

Your steps

1. List three rival explanations using the supplied details.
2. For each, write one sentence explaining how it could increase museum visits. Mark these as possibilities, not established causes.
3. Choose one rival and name a comparison that would help distinguish it from the effect of price.

Before you finish: Have you explained a plausible connection for each rival instead of merely listing coinciding events?

Your response

Exit ticket / The library app launch

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: Library loans rise in the month a booking app launches. The library also extends opening hours and starts a popular reading challenge that month. The director credits the app alone.

Produce: Write two alternative explanations and one comparison that could help test the app.

Your steps

1. Explain how longer opening hours could increase loans.
2. Explain how the reading challenge could increase loans.
3. Describe a comparison with and without the app that keeps the other two changes comparable.

Before you finish: Are your explanations possibilities, and would the comparison separate the app from the other changes?

Your response